

September

26



Aerial feat 2008

Dropping from an aircraft above Calais, France, Swiss pilot Yves Rossy used one of his inventions – a set of carbon-fibre wings powered by four jet engines – to fly 35 km (22 miles) across the English Channel, landing in the British town of Dover.



2009 Bottle ban

Stores in the town of Bundanoon, Australia, stopped selling bottled water, making the town the first place in the world to enforce a ban on plastic bottles, which harm the environment.

Also on this day

1887 US journalist **Nellie Bly** entered an asylum as an undercover patient to reveal the harsh treatment of people suffering from mental illnesses.

1905 German-born US physicist **Albert Einstein** published a research paper introducing his theory of special relativity, which is concerned with the nature of space and time.

1969 *Abbey Road*, the final studio album recorded by British band The Beatles, was released.

Born this day

1981 **Serena Williams**, Black American tennis player. She has won 23 women's singles Grand Slams, the second-highest number of titles in tennis history.

2018

Feathered giants

A research paper in the *Royal Society Open Science* journal confirmed that the elephant birds of Madagascar were the largest birds ever to have lived.

These flightless birds, which died out more than 1,000 years ago, were 3 m (10 ft) in height.

